Snapmint Case Study - Why Snapmint Is Losing Users at the Moment of Purchase

Theme: Building Trust in a BNPL Shopping Experience

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> 💡 **Case Study at a Glance**
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> Snapmint is a BNPL (Buy Now Pay Later) shopping platform targeting first-time credit users in India. Despite offering a genuinely useful service for people who have no credit card access, the app struggles to convert interested users into paying customers. This case study explores why that gap exists, who is most affected, and what product decisions can close it.

📌 01. Problem Framing

Snapmint sits in an interesting position. It serves a real need for millions of young Indians who cannot access traditional credit. The demand is there. The intent is there. But something breaks between the moment a user lands on the app and the moment they complete a purchase.

After personally installing and using the app, and going through hundreds of user reviews on the Play Store and online forums, one pattern became impossible to ignore. Users are not leaving because the idea of BNPL does not appeal to them. They are leaving because the app does not give them enough confidence to trust it with their money.

No product reviews. No visible warranty. No easy way to reach support. No order confirmation after payment. These are not minor UX problems. For a first-time buyer spending thousands of rupees on a phone or gadget, these are deal-breakers.

> 🔴 **Official Problem Statement**
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> Snapmint users show strong purchase intent but drop off at the point of buying, due to a lack of trust signals, poor product discovery, an absent cart system, and inaccessible customer support. This results in low purchase conversion and poor user retention on the platform.

👤 02. User Personas

Snapmint's users are not one type of person. Three distinct user groups were identified through app research and Play Store review analysis. Each comes to Snapmint with different motivations and different pain points.

> 🧠 **Common Thread Across All Three Personas**
>
> Rahul, Priya, and Suresh come from different backgrounds and have different use cases. But they share one thing: they are all first-time or early-stage credit users who need maximum reassurance before committing money on an unfamiliar platform. Trust is the universal unlock for all three.

Persona 1 - Struggling Rahul 🎓

Every product decision in this case study is made with one person in mind. Rahul is 19 to 25 years old, living in any Indian city. He is a college student or a fresh graduate. He earns nothing or maybe 5,000 to 10,000 rupees a month from a part-time gig. He wants to buy a phone, a pair of earphones, or something for his room. But he has no credit card. No credit history. And asking his parents feels uncomfortable.

Snapmint is not just convenient for Rahul. For him, it is the only realistic option.

Attribute	Detail
Age	19 to 25 years old
Location	Any city in India - Tier 1, Tier 2, or Tier 3
Occupation	College student or fresh graduate
Monthly Income	Zero or part-time earnings of 5,000 to 10,000 rupees
Goal	Buy gadgets, clothes, or accessories now and pay later
Core Problem	No credit card, no credit history, parents will not fund large purchases
Why Snapmint	Only realistic option for EMI without a credit card
Biggest Fear	If something goes wrong with my order, no one will help me and I will lose my money

> 🎯 **Rahul's Core Job**

> When I want something I cannot afford right now, I want a safe and simple way to split the payment into installments, so that I can buy it without asking my parents or waiting months to save up.

What makes Rahul different from a typical ecommerce buyer is the stakes involved. He is likely making one of his first major financial commitments without any adult supervision or safety net. For him, trust is not a nice-to-have feature. It is the entire reason he will or will not complete the purchase.

Persona 2 - Working Priya 💼

Priya is 24 to 28 years old, working her first job in a Tier 2 city like Indore, Nagpur, or Jaipur. She earns between 18,000 and 30,000 rupees a month. She has a debit card but no credit card yet. She wants to buy home decor, ethnic wear for festivals, or a skincare routine she saw on Instagram. She can afford it in installments but not in one shot.

Priya is practical and impatient. If the app feels confusing or untrustworthy, she will close it and order from Myntra or Meesho instead.

Attribute	Detail
Age	24 to 28 years old
Location	Tier 2 cities - Indore, Nagpur, Jaipur, Bhopal
Occupation	First job - BPO, teacher, junior executive
Monthly Income	18,000 to 30,000 rupees
Goal	Buy fashion, home decor, and lifestyle products on easy EMI
Core Problem	No credit card, debit card only, no credit score yet
Why Snapmint	EMI without credit card for categories she loves
Biggest Fear	Buying the wrong size or product and not being able to return it easily

> 🎯 **Priya's Core Job**

> When I find something I love online, I want to buy it immediately in affordable installments without going through a complicated credit application, so I can enjoy it now and manage my budget month by month.

Priya's biggest drop-off moment is when she cannot find gender-specific categories quickly or when there is no 7-day return option visible. She does not want to take a risk on a platform that might not cooperate when something goes wrong.

Persona 3 - Small Town Suresh 🏪

Suresh is 30 to 38 years old, running a small kirana shop or working as a daily wage earner in a semi-urban town in UP, Bihar, or Rajasthan. He earns between 12,000 and 20,000 rupees a month but has no formal banking credit relationship. He wants to buy a smartphone to manage his shop's UPI payments, or a fan and cooler for his home before summer. He has seen BNPL ads on YouTube and wants to try it but does not trust apps he does not recognize.

Suresh is the most skeptical user on this list. He needs the most hand-holding and has the lowest tolerance for friction.

Attribute	Detail
Age	30 to 38 years old
Location	Semi-urban towns - Tier 3 and Tier 4 cities
Occupation	Kirana shop owner, daily wage worker, small trader
Monthly Income	12,000 to 20,000 rupees
Goal	Buy essential electronics like smartphone, fan, or cooler on EMI
Core Problem	No bank credit access, no credit history, no credit card
Why Snapmint	Only EMI option available without formal bank relationship
Biggest Fear	Getting cheated - losing money to a fake app or receiving a fake product

> 🎯 **Suresh's Core Job**

> When I need a big-ticket item for my home or business, I want a trustworthy way to pay in small monthly amounts, so that I do not have to drain my savings or borrow from someone I know.

Suresh is the user who reads every review, asks around before installing, and will abandon the purchase if he cannot find a customer support number. For him, Snapmint's trust gap is not just a UX issue - it is a fundamental barrier to ever completing a purchase.

🔍 03. Root Cause Analysis

To understand where users drop off, it helps to walk through the exact journey inside the app.

Rahul's Drop-off Journey

Stage	What Happens
Opens the app	Rahul is curious and motivated. He has heard about BNPL and wants to try it.
Browses products	He finds something he likes - a phone or earphones. He is interested.
Looks for reviews	No user ratings. No buyer feedback. He wonders if the product is genuine.
Checks EMI options	Only 3-month EMI available. That means 4,000 rupees per month for a 12,000 rupee phone. Too high.
Tries to add two items	No cart. He cannot combine purchases. He has to buy one at a time.
Looks for warranty info	Nothing visible. No assurance that the product is covered if something goes wrong.
Contacts support	No live chat. No visible phone number. No easy way to get help.
Exits the app	He opens Flipkart instead. More expensive, but at least he trusts it.

Root Causes Bucketed

Root Cause	Impact on Users
No product reviews or ratings	Cannot judge product quality or authenticity before buying

Root Cause	Impact on Users
No warranty or product assurance	Too risky for big purchases like phones or gadgets
No cart system	Cannot combine multiple items into one purchase or EMI
Limited EMI tenure options	3-month EMI feels unaffordable; 6 or 12 months would completely change the math
No gender or category filters	Product discovery is slow and frustrating — especially for Priya
No user profile section	App feels anonymous with no purchase history or personalization
Poor customer support access	No safety net if the order goes wrong — critical blocker for Suresh

> 🧠 **The One Core Finding**

> Snapmint was built for transactions. It was not built for trust. The payment mechanics work, but the product forgot that its users are first-time buyers who need maximum hand-holding and assurance before, during, and after every purchase.

A Psychological Insight on EMI Tenure

The difference between a 3-month and a 12-month EMI option is not just financial. It is psychological.

EMI Tenure	Monthly Amount on a 12,000 Rupee Phone
3 months	4,000 rupees per month - feels unaffordable
6 months	2,000 rupees per month -manageable
12 months	1,000 rupees per month -comfortable

Same product. Same total cost. But the 12-month option makes it feel four times more affordable. For Rahul and Suresh, this is the difference between walking away and completing the purchase.

⭐ 04. North Star Metric

> 📊 **North Star Metric**

> Monthly Successful Purchase Completion Rate - the percentage of users who viewed a product and completed the purchase within 7 days.

This metric was chosen because it sits at the exact intersection of all three core problems Snapmint faces.

Why This NSM	Explanation
Measures trust	If users trust the platform, they complete purchases. The NSM goes up.
Measures UX quality	If the cart, EMI options, and filters work well, conversion improves directly.
Measures business health	Snapmint only earns when a purchase happens. The NSM tracks the real revenue signal.

💡 05. Feature Recommendations

All of these features came from real observations inside the app combined with user review research. Each one maps directly to a specific point in the drop-off journey across all three personas.

Feature 1 - Verified Buyer Review and Rating System

Right now, every product page on Snapmint shows zero reviews. For Rahul spending thousands of rupees, this is a silent red flag. For Suresh, it is a deal-breaker. Adding a verified buyer review system, where only confirmed purchasers can leave a rating - would immediately build social proof and reduce hesitation at the most critical moment of the purchase journey.

Feature 2 - In-App Support Center with Live Chat and Call Option

The most common complaint across user reviews is that Snapmint's customer support is unreachable. No live chat, no visible phone number, no FAQ section inside the app. For a platform where users are trusting it with real money, this is a serious gap. A dedicated support section with live chat, a callback option, and a searchable FAQ would give all three personas the confidence that someone is there if something goes wrong.

Feature 3 - Multi-Product Cart with Combined EMI Calculation

Currently every product must be purchased separately. If Rahul wants to buy a phone and earphones together, he goes through two full purchase flows and manages two separate EMI schedules. A cart system that combines selected items and calculates a single combined EMI across flexible tenures of 3, 6, or 12 months would reduce friction and increase average order value at the same time.

Feature 4 - User Profile and Purchase History Dashboard

Snapmint has no user profile section. Users cannot see past orders, ongoing EMI schedules, or account details in one place. A simple profile dashboard would make the app feel more legitimate, improve retention, and reduce support queries since users could self-serve most order-related questions.

Feature 5 - 7-Day Hassle-Free Return Policy with In-App Initiation

One of Priya's biggest fears before buying is that she has no recourse if the product is defective or not as described. A clearly communicated 7-day return policy, initiated directly inside the app without needing to call anyone, removes a major psychological barrier before purchase. When users know they can return something easily, they buy with more confidence.

Feature 6 - Real-Time Order Tracking

Multiple users complained about not receiving a confirmation email after purchasing and having no way to track their order inside the app. A simple tracking flow showing the stages from order confirmed to shipped to out for delivery would eliminate post-purchase anxiety and reduce support queries significantly.

Feature 7 - Gender and Category-Based Product Discovery

Browsing Snapmint currently requires scrolling through a mixed catalogue with no clear way to filter by gender or category. Adding simple discovery filters for men, women, electronics, fashion, and other categories would directly solve Priya's drop-off moment and make the experience feel more personal for all users.

🎯 06. RICE Prioritization

RICE scoring assigns a numerical priority to each feature based on Reach (how many users are affected), Impact (how much it will move the needle), Confidence (how certain we are it will work), and Effort (how hard it is to build). The formula is Reach multiplied by Impact multiplied by Confidence, divided by Effort.

Feature	Reach	Impact	Confidence	Effort	RICE Score	Priority
Verified Buyer Reviews	9	9	8	4	162	P1
In-App Support Center	9	9	9	5	145	P1
Multi-Product Cart	8	8	8	6	85	P2
User Profile Dashboard	7	7	7	5	69	P2
7-Day Return Policy	8	8	7	7	64	P2

Feature	Reach	Impact	Confidence	Effort	RICE Score	Priority
Real-Time Order Tracking	6	7	7	8	37	P3
Gender and Category Filters	7	6	8	3	112	P3

> 📝 **Note on Prioritization**

> Gender and Category Filters scored 112 on RICE but were placed in P3. The reason is that trust-building features directly drive purchase conversion, which is the core problem. Filters improve discovery but do not solve the underlying fear of transacting. The return policy, despite a lower RICE score, was moved to P2 because it directly removes a pre-purchase psychological barrier - most critical for Priya.

📊 07. Success Metrics

The primary measure of success for this entire initiative is the Monthly Purchase Conversion Rate reaching 12 to 15 percent within six months of shipping the P1 and P2 features.

Metric	Current State	Target (6 Months)
Monthly Purchase Conversion Rate (NSM)	3 to 5% estimated	12 to 15%
Monthly Active Users (MAU)	Baseline	+25% growth
Cart Abandonment Rate	High	Reduce by 30%
Customer Support Resolution Time	48 to 72 hours	Under 4 hours
Review Submission Rate	Near 0%	20% of buyers leave a review
Repeat Purchase Rate	Low	+40% in 6 months
Return Rate	Unknown	Under 8%

> 📌 **Industry Benchmark Context**

> Amazon and Flipkart convert at 8 to 12 percent. Average ecommerce in India sits at 2 to 4 percent. A BNPL platform with strong trust signals should realistically target 10 to 15 percent. The 12 to 15 percent goal is ambitious but grounded in real benchmarks.

🖼️ 08. Figma Wireframes

The wireframes below cover the 4 most critical screens identified in this case study. Each screen maps directly to a root cause and its corresponding feature recommendation.

> ✏️ **Wireframe Screens to Build in Figma**

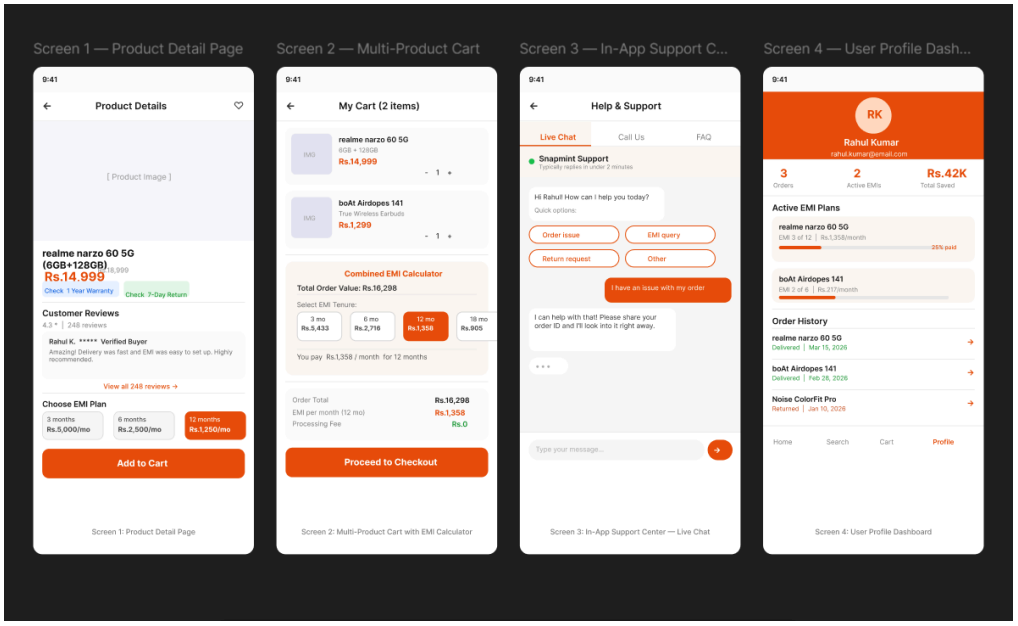
> 1. Product Detail Page - with Verified Reviews and Warranty Badge

> 2. Multi-Product Cart - with Combined EMI Calculator (3, 6, 12 month options)

> 3. In-App Support Center - Live Chat, Call, and FAQ tabs

> 4. User Profile Dashboard - Orders, EMI Schedule, Account Details

Figma Wireframes — 4 Screens



- Screen 1: Product Detail Page with Verified Reviews and Warranty Badge
- Screen 2: Multi-Product Cart with Combined EMI Calculator
- Screen 3: In app support center
- Screen 4: User Profile Dashboard

Final Figma Link: https://www.figma.com/design/pTZBCDI9BPkZyslVdhfwF7/Snapmint-Product-Case-Study?node-id=0-1&p=f&t=LqBLfPTtmbzY8eIP-0

> 🏁 **Final Thought**
>
> Snapmint does not have a product problem. It has a trust problem. The BNPL concept works. The demand is real. Rahul needs confidence before he buys. Priya needs assurance she can return. Suresh needs proof that someone will pick up the phone. Fix the trust across all three users, and the conversions will follow.

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